



Paratroopers hold back a crowd of French nationals angry at news of self-determination for Algeria.



First man in space

Yuri Gagarin is pictured here in the cockpit of his spacecraft, Vostok 1. His groundbreaking first flight into space lasted 1 hour 45 minutes.

place on April 29, in Switzerland. The "**Morges Manifesto**" became the blueprint for the first global green organization, the World Wildlife Fund (WWF). The organization's headquarters were established in Switzerland, and national offices were gradually set up across the world, starting with Britain, in November. South America's first ever **National Park** was also established this year, in Brazil. The government created the 5.6 million acre (2.3 million hectare) **Xingu National Park** to resettle the indigenous people of Brazil, as their lands were taken over and developed. Seventeen tribes were settled in the new park.

South Africa focused on its anti-British policies and won the vote for **independence** on May 31.

It became a republic and left the Commonwealth. In the same year, **Nelson Mandela** (b. 1918) headed the ANC's new military wing, and launched a sabotage campaign.

President Charles de Gaulle called for **self-determination in Algeria** (see 1954), but the atmosphere between France and Algeria remained murderous. French settlers living in Algeria reacted with outrage, and France braced itself for civil war. On October 17, thousands of **Algerians converged on Paris** to protest against repressive measures taken against them. About 10,000 people were arrested and **hundreds were killed**.

Berliners found themselves living in a physically divided city on August 13, as troops in East Germany closed the border between **East and West Berlin**. Barbed wire fences up to 6 ft (2m) high were erected. Within days, these were replaced by concrete blocks, and the **wall became permanent** (see 1989).

THE PORTUGUESE LUXURY PASSENGER LINER SANTA MARIA

was hijacked in January while sailing in West Indian waters. The hijackers were **Iberian leftists** who opposed the Portuguese government and the fascist regime in Spain. The 900 people on board were released after 11 days.

The Soviet Union scored a victory in the **space race** when **Yuri Gagarin** (1934–68) became the first man to be launched into

space. He **orbited the Earth** just once on April 12, traveling at more than 17,000 miles per hour (27,000 km per hour) in his **Vostok 1** spacecraft.

In 1960, the Russians had scored a triumph by winning the allegiance of **Fidel Castro**, the newly installed dictator of Cuba (see panel, opposite). Washington responded in April by financing 1,500 anti-communist exiles in the ill-fated "**Bay of Pigs**" expedition. This badly conceived attempt at

invasion on the southern coast was immediately repulsed (see 1962).

One of **John F. Kennedy's** first proposals as US president was the establishment of a **Peace Corps** to help in developing nations. The aim was for young people to take one or two years **working abroad** as teachers, healthcare workers, or advisors in Africa, Asia, and South America.

Worldwide action to conserve the **natural world** was put in



Dividing wall

The Berlin Wall enclosed the three sectors of West Berlin, separating it from East Berlin and East Germany.

KEY

— Berlin Wall
— Berlin city limits

